

and environmental systems. As an overseer there is also the Nanotechnology Institute, which is a multistate initiative involving academic and research institutions, corporate partners, private investors, as well as government types interested in supporting economic development. The states participating include New Jersey, Pennsylvania, Maryland, and Delaware – including some international alliances with Japan, Italy, and the United Kingdom thrown in for good measure.

Europe

Europe, now-a-day, sees itself as one large community, in all fields including currency, sports, or technology. As a result, there are a few key Euro-wide organizations driving nanotechnology efforts. The European Union met in March 2000 and charged the European Commission with creating a market for science and technology within a disciplinary division called the European Research Area (ERA) with a budget of 1.3 billion euros. Within the ERA there are a number of technology platforms that are devoted to Nanotechnology like “The Nanobiotechnologies for Medical Applications” and “The European Nanoelectronics Initiative Advisory Council.” The European Union has also sponsored the Thematic Network to provide a one-stop source of information for all areas of nanotechnology to business, scientific researchers, and communities. The bottomline remains that Europe is still feeling its way in the nano-realm, defining goals, potential programs, and synergies. But their combined energy will make them bigger players in the years to come.

Japan

In Japan, the nanotech research is overseen by The Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology and the Ministry of Economy, Trade, and Industry. Japan wants to promote basic research and development in areas that meet society’s needs – the life sciences, for example – as well as information and communications technology, and environmental sciences. Japanese efforts in the nanoelectronic devices area will undoubtedly be controlled by technology giants such as NEC, Hitachi, Fujitsu, and Toshiba, whereas pharmaceutical companies will steer development on the biotechnology side. The Council for Scientific and Technological Policy and The Institute of Physical and Chemical Research are some of the key players in Nanotechnology research, along with Tokyo University, the Tokyo Institute of Technology, Osaka University, and Kyoto University